

VPA ICT — Grades 2–3 Term 1: Digital Basics

Term 1: Digital Basics — Weeks 1 – 12

Theme: Computer parts, mouse/keyboard, typing, safe searching | Duration: 40 minutes per lesson

Term Overview

Students explore the physical components of computers, develop fundamental mouse and keyboard skills, and begin typing with correct finger placement. By the end of Term 1, students can identify key computer parts, use a mouse with precision, and type simple words and sentences using two hands.

Week-by-Week Scheme of Work

Week 1 — Welcome to the Computer Lab

Keywords: computer 电脑 (diànnǎo), keyboard 键盘 (jiànpán), mouse 鼠标 (shǔbiāo), screen 屏幕 (píngmù)

Activity 1 (15 min): "Computer Parts Scavenger Hunt" — Students walk around the lab with a picture checklist, finding and touching each part (monitor, keyboard, mouse, CPU, cables). They match pictures to labels.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Simon Says" in English — "Simon says touch the monitor!" Reinforces vocabulary through movement.

Activity 3 (10 min): Coloring worksheet — Label computer parts in English with Chinese translations.

Formative: Observation checklist — Can the student point to 4/5 computer parts correctly?

Week 2 — Mouse Skills

Keywords: click 点击 (diǎnjī), double-click 双击 (shuāngjī), drag 拖动 (tuōdòng), right-click 右键 (yòujiàn), cursor 光标 (guāngbiāo)

Activity 1 (15 min): "Catch the Butterfly" — Online mouse practice game. Students move the cursor to catch butterflies, practicing pointing and clicking.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Drag and Drop Puzzle" — Jigsaw puzzles using drag-and-drop (e.g., ABCya.com puzzles). Students drag pieces to complete pictures.

Activity 3 (10 min): "Right-Click Rainbow" — Students right-click on different objects to see the menu, then change colors.

Formative: Can the student complete a 6-piece drag-and-drop puzzle in under 3 minutes?

Week 3 — Keyboard Introduction

Keywords: keyboard 键盘 (jiànpán), space bar 空格键 (kònggé jiàn), enter/return 回车键 (huíchē jiàn), delete/backspace 删除键 (shānchú jiàn), shift 上档键 (shàngdàng jiàn)

Activity 1 (15 min): "Keyboard Carpet Mat" — Large floor keyboard mat. Students physically walk to keys called out by teacher. "Stand on the letter A!" "Jump to the space bar!"

Activity 2 (15 min): Keyboard exploration — Students press each letter key and say its name aloud. Teacher models correct finger placement on home row (ASDF JKL;).

Activity 3 (10 min): "Type the Alphabet" — Students type A to Z, saying each letter as they type. Teacher circulates to check finger placement.

Formative: Finger placement check — Are both hands on home row?

Week 4 — Typing Letters

Keywords: home row 基准键行 (jīzhǔn jiàn háng), finger placement 手指位置 (shǒuzhǐ wèizhì), uppercase 大写 (dàxiě), lowercase 小写 (xiǎoxiě)

Activity 1 (15 min): BBC Dance Mat Typing Level 1 (Stage 1) — Students practice home row keys with guided animation.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Letter Race" — Teacher calls out a letter; first student to type it correctly wins a point. Uses only home row keys.

Activity 3 (10 min): Worksheet — Students color-code a keyboard diagram: left hand keys = blue, right hand keys = red.

Formative: Typing speed check — How many home row letters can they type in 1 minute? (Target: 15+ correct keystrokes)

Week 5 — Typing Numbers

Keywords: number pad 数字键盘 (shùzì jiànpán), num lock 数字锁定 (shùzì suǒdìng), top row numbers 数字行 (shùzì háng)

Activity 1 (15 min): "Number Treasure Hunt" — Students type sequences: 1, 2, 3... 1, 3, 5... their age, their class number.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Number Patterns" — Type 10-20-30-40... then 5-10-15-20... Recognizing patterns on the number row.

Activity 3 (10 min): Number typing game — Students race to type a list of 10 numbers correctly.

Formative: Can type numbers 0-9 in order in under 30 seconds.

Week 6 — Typing Words

Keywords: word 单词 (dāncí), space 空格 (kònggé), sentence 句子 (jùzi), punctuation 标点符号 (biāodiǎn fúhào)

Activity 1 (15 min): "My Name Challenge" — Students type their first and last name 5 times. Teacher models capital letter using Shift.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Animal Words" — Students type simple animal words: cat, dog, pig, cow, duck, bird. Focus on not looking at hands.

Activity 3 (10 min): Word bank practice — Pre-printed word list with pictures. Students type each word next to the picture.

Formative: Can type their full name with correct capitalization.

Week 7 — Typing Sentences

Keywords: period/full stop 句号 (jùhào), question mark 问号 (wèn hào), exclamation mark 感叹号 (gǎntànhào), capital letter 大写字母 (dàxiě zìmǔ)

Activity 1 (15 min): "Sentence Frames" — Students complete and type: "My name is _____. I am in Grade ____." Focus on spaces and periods.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Dictation Typing" — Teacher reads simple sentences; students type them. "The cat is big." "I like red."

Activity 3 (10 min): Self-check — Students read their sentences aloud. Partner checks for spaces and periods.

Formative: Typed sentences contain correct spaces and ending punctuation.

Week 8 — Review & Typing Olympics

Activity 1 (20 min): "Typing Olympics" — Stations: (1) Letter sprint, (2) Number dash, (3) Word challenge, (4) Sentence builder.

Activity 2 (15 min): Medal ceremony — Students earn bronze, silver, or gold certificates based on performance.

Activity 3 (5 min): Reflection journal — "This term, I learned to type..."

Week 9 — Introduction to the Internet

Keywords: internet 互联网 (hùliánwǎng), website 网站 (wǎngzhàn), browser 浏览器 (liúlǎnqì), URL/address 网址 (wǎngzhǐ), link 链接 (liànjiē)

Activity 1 (15 min): "What is the Internet?" — Picture-based discussion. Teacher uses analogy: "The internet is like a library with billions of books."

Activity 2 (15 min): "Browser Buttons" — Students identify back, forward, refresh, home buttons. Practice navigating between 3 pre-selected safe sites.

Activity 3 (10 min): Safe sites treasure map — Students "collect" stamps by visiting 3 approved websites and drawing what they found.

Formative: Can use back/forward buttons independently.

Week 10 — Safe Searching

Keywords: search 搜索 (sōusuǒ), search engine 搜索引擎 (sōusuǒ yǐnqíng), safe search 安全搜索 (ānquán sōusuǒ), keyword 关键词 (guānjiàncí)

Activity 1 (15 min): Kiddle.net demonstration — Teacher models safe searching for "pandas." Students observe how to type a keyword and press Enter.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Animal Search" — Students search for a favorite animal on Kiddle. They copy one picture and one fact into a simple template.

Activity 3 (10 min): Discussion — "What do you do if you see something that makes you scared?" (Tell a trusted adult.)

Formative: Can perform a simple search using Kiddle.net with teacher support.

Week 11 — Digital Citizenship Basics

Keywords: digital citizen 数字公民 (shùzì gōngmín), online 在线 (zàixiàn), offline 离线 (líxiàn), safe 安全 (ānquán), unsafe 不安全 (bù ānquán)

Activity 1 (15 min): "Good Choice / Bad Choice" sorting game — Picture cards show scenarios: sharing a password, telling an adult about a pop-up, meeting an online "friend." Students sort into good/bad.

Activity 2 (15 min): "Stop, Think, Click" song — Students learn and perform a song about pausing before clicking.

Activity 3 (10 min): Poster creation — In pairs, students create a "Stay Safe Online" poster with 3 rules.

Formative: Can identify 3/5 safe online behaviors correctly.

Week 12 — Term 1 Assessment

Practical Assessment (20 min):

Type their name, age, and class (5 min)

Use mouse to complete a 4-step task: open browser → go to Kiddle → search for "tigers" → close browser (10 min)

Point to 5 computer parts on a diagram (5 min)

Oral Assessment (15 min): Teacher interviews each student using sentence frames: "What do you do if a stranger asks your name online?"

Portfolio Check (5 min): Review saved work from the term.

Common Core / CSTA Standards Mapping

Weeks	Standard	Description
1 - 3	CSTA 1A-CS-01	Select and operate appropriate software to perform tasks
1 - 3	CSTA 1A-CS-02	Use computing devices to achieve learning goals
4 - 8	CCSS. ELA. L. 2. 2	Demonstrate command of standard English capitalization and punctuation
9 - 11	CSTA 1A-IC-17	Work respectfully and responsibly with others online
9 - 11	CCSS. ELA. SL. 2. 2	Recount key details from information presented orally

Differentiation Summary

Level	Typing	Mouse	Internet
Bronze	One-hand typing, hunt-and-peck OK	Trackpad with hand-over-hand support	Teacher navigates, student observes
Silver	Two hands, some looking	Independent mouse use	Guided navigation with checklist
Gold	Touch typing emerging, no looking	Proficient, helps peers	Independent searching, helps others